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Black nomads of the Sahara

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Document Type: Book

Original Page: 250

Culture (OWC): [Teda \(MS22\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Central Africa

Field Date: Ca. 1930-1955

Coverage Date: 1930-1957

Place Coverage: Tibesti, Chad

Section Title(S): 1. Social Rituals And Obligations.

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Behavior Toward Non-
Relatives

In the daily life of the camp, manner are more affable. Upon entering a tent, a man removes his sandals and leaves them at the door. He squats down in front of the persons present and shakes hands. They exchange greetings: Kallaha Kallahali ("Peace, is there peace?") Kallahih. ("There is peace.") Kallahalei ("May there be peace.") Kallahalei ge. ("Yes, may there be peace.") Then, very low: N'di mazo? ("What have you heard?") Kallaha. -N'di durumi? ("What have you seen?") Kallaha.(2)

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Etiquette

In speaking, the men hold themselves a little sideways from one another and do not look at each other, especially if they are of different ages or a family tie implies respect. They speak in a low voice and their features remain impassive. Between people of the same generation the attitude is freer, the voice normal, or else very much raised and sometimes even sharp, and accompanied by such lively gestures that one would believe there is a quarrel, whereas the conversation proceeds normally.

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Conversation

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Age Stratification

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And Groups

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In a serious dispute, on the other hand, before it comes to cries and blows, they speak calmly and in a very low voice, in a strange tone, with a solemn air which is like a warning. Once anger breaks out, there is no more holding back.

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Ingroup Antagonisms

Politeness between the sexes is strict. Women do not eat in front of men, they eat only with women or, if need be, with their brothers or first cousins. In order to speak to a man, a woman squats on her heels without sitting down altogether and holds herself slantwise without looking at her interlocutor. It is bad form to be looked at.

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General Sex
Restrictions

One does not joke in front of old people, and certain subjects of conversation are thus forbidden or considered sensitive. ■251310 cont. It is impolite to ask a man questions to which he cannot reply without exposing himself to an inaccuracy. This is especially so in the case of relations between families-in-law that are sort of bashful, or reserved. Thus a man may not make an allusion to the fiance or husband of his sister. If he is obliged to mention a member of his family by marriage, he uses a paraphrase. (3)

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Parents-In-Law And
Children-In-Law

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Status And Treatment
Of The Aged

2. Ch. Le Coeur, [Dictionnaire ethnographique tédá](#) /Teda ethnographic dictionary/, p. 136, see the word [lahannor](#), "to greet."

3. Let us recall that there is a rule that one does not eat or drink in front of one's in-laws who are older than oneself. When his mother-in-law enters his tent, the son-in-law leaves.

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